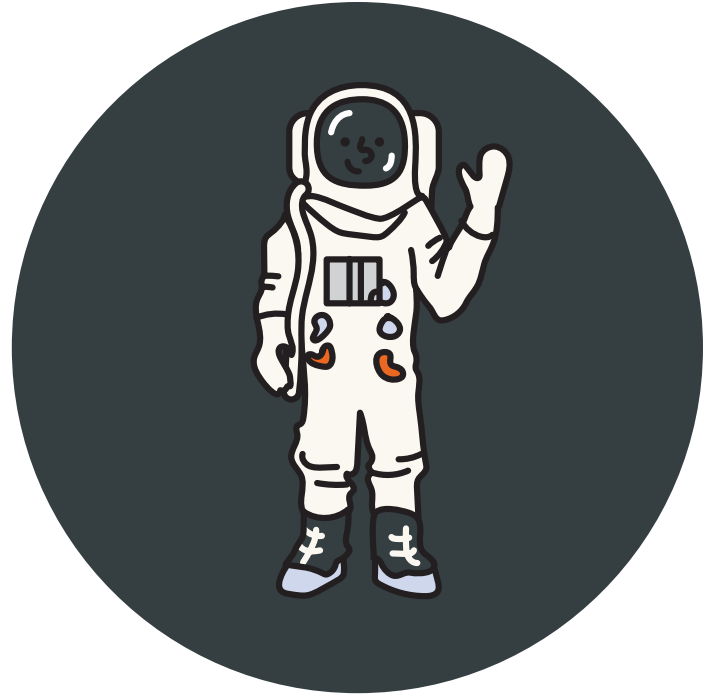


Astronauts

Pre-Reading

A. Warm-Up Questions

- 1 What does it feel like to be in space?
- 2 How do astronauts train for their job?
- 3 What different jobs do astronauts have in space?



B. Vocabulary Preview

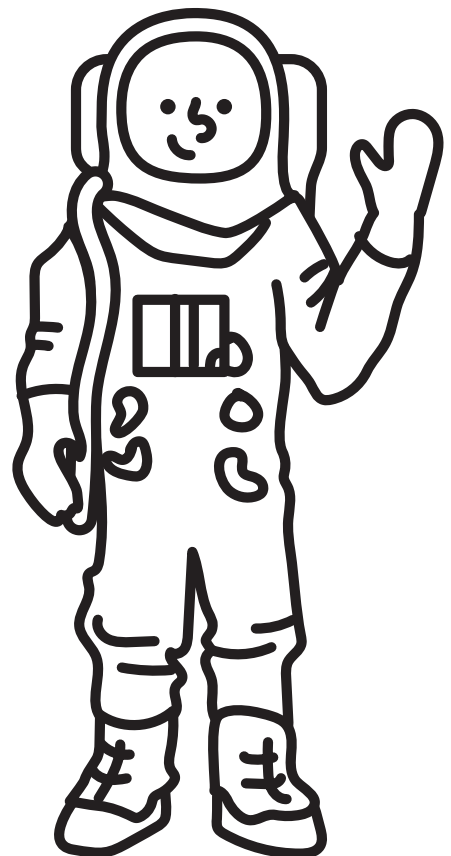
Match up as many words and meanings as you can. Check this exercise again after seeing the words in context on page 2.

- | | |
|-----------------------|--|
| _____ 1 gravity | (a) to get/make bigger or longer |
| _____ 2 spine | (b) a natural force that attracts objects to earth |
| _____ 3 stretch | (c) the row of bones down the middle of your back |
| _____ 4 shrink | (d) related to many countries |
| _____ 5 international | (e) to get smaller or shorter |

Reading

Astronauts

- 1 Did you know that astronauts grow in space? Their **spines stretch** because there is no **gravity**. Astronauts **shrink** back to regular size on Earth.
- 2 Most of an astronaut's training is done on Earth. They learn what space feels like on a special training aeroplane. Astronauts nicknamed this plane the 'vomit comet'. It drops down very fast for 30 seconds. In a real spaceship, astronauts only feel sick for a few days.
- 3 Working in space is a lot like working in water. The word astronaut means 'star sailor'. Astronauts in training swim in a large pool in their space suits and running shoes.
- 4 There are lots of different jobs in space. Some astronauts are pilots, and some are scientists. Others are space walkers. Astronauts from around the world work on the **International Space Station (ISS)**.



Comprehension

Discuss these questions in pairs and write the answers below.

1 What happens to an astronaut's body in space?

2 Name two places where astronauts train.

3 What is the 'vomit comet'?

4 What does the word 'astronaut' mean?

5 What types of jobs do astronauts have in space?

Bonus Question

Can you guess what Yuri Malanchenko did on the International Space Station?

- ☐ quit his job
- ☐ got married
- ☐ ate a McDonald's hamburger
- ☐ wrote a book

Practice

A. Word Jumble

Read the clues and try to unscramble the words.

#	Clue	Scrambled	Unscrambled
1	There is none of this in space.	vitragy	
2	to get smaller	inksrh	
3	involves more than one country	tenirantionla	
4	row of bones in a person's back	sinpe	
5	to make your body bigger	ttrechs	

B. True or False?

Write T if the statement is true and F if it is false.

- _____ 1 Astronauts shrink in space.
- _____ 2 The International Space Station is only for American astronauts.
- _____ 3 People sometimes vomit when they feel sick.
- _____ 4 A sailor works in the skies.
- _____ 5 Before you get a job, you might get special training.

Listening

Listen to a recording of this reading.

Fill in the blanks. Listen again and check your answers.

Astronauts

- 1 Did you know that astronauts grow in space? Their spines _____ because there is no gravity. Astronauts _____ back to regular size on Earth.
- 2 Most of an astronaut's training is done on Earth. They learn what space feels like on a special training aeroplane. _____ nicknamed this plane the 'vomit comet'. It drops down very fast for 30 seconds. In a real _____, astronauts only feel sick for a few days.
- 3 Working in space is a lot like working in water. The word astronaut means 'star _____'. Astronauts in _____ swim in a large pool in their space suits and running shoes.
- 4 There are lots of different jobs in space. Some astronauts are _____, and some are scientists. Others are space walkers. Astronauts from around the world work on the _____ Space Station (ISS).

Answer Key

Lesson Description:

Students learn about astronauts through reading, speaking, listening, and vocabulary tasks.

Level: Low Int - Int

Time: 1-2 hours

Tags: astronauts, reading, discussion, vocabulary, discovery center

Pre-Reading

A. Warm-Up Questions

Answers will vary.

B. Vocabulary Preview

1. b 2. c 3. a 4. e 5. d

Reading

Read individually, in small groups, or as a class. You can also play the listening as your students read along. A gap-fill version of the reading is available on page 5. Help your students with vocabulary and expressions that they are unfamiliar with.

Comprehension

1. An astronaut's spine grows in space.
2. Astronauts train in aeroplanes and swimming pools.
3. The vomit comet is a special plane that helps astronauts feel like they are in space.
4. The word 'astronaut' means 'star sailor'.
5. Astronauts have lots of jobs. They can be pilots, scientists, or space walkers.

Bonus Answer: He got married. (His wife was in Texas standing beside a cardboard cutout of him. The marriage ceremony took place via satellite.)

Practice

A. Word Jumble

- | | | |
|------------|------------------|------------|
| 1. gravity | 3. international | 5. stretch |
| 2. shrink | 4. spine | |

B. True or False?

1. F 2. F 3. T 4. F 5. T

(continued on the next page...)

Answer Key cont.

Listening

1. stretch, shrink
2. Astronauts, spaceship
3. sailor, training
4. pilots, International

More Facts to Share:

1. It takes about 8.5 minutes for astronauts to reach space.
2. Since November 2000, there has always been a crew of astronauts at the International Space Station.
3. Astronauts hopped on the moon. The moon has some gravity, but not as much as Earth. It was easier to hop than walk.
4. Exercise is important in space. Astronauts have to move their muscles every day in space.
5. Astronauts sleep in special sleeping bags that stop them from floating.
6. In 2004, Leroy Chiao became the first American astronaut to vote for a president in space.
7. A Russian astronaut is called a cosmonaut.

Editor's Note:

Students who complete a task quickly can colour in the image on page 2.